

financial drain. Some simply weren't ready to live on their own (and were self-aware about it).

On *Late Night with Seth Meyers* in 2015, Dr. Jill Biden, former Vice President Joe Biden's wife, called community college "the best kept secret in America." The Northern Virginia Community College professor said people judge the education as subpar, but Dr. Biden asserts, "I know differently and so do the millions of people across the country who have received an affordable, quality higher education at community college."

It's not all roses, though. One student at Palm Beach State College said her sister, who attends a private college, berates her for her choice. One said she was afraid to tell her friends. Even Palm Beach itself felt that it needed to up its game: in 2010, it rebranded from Palm Beach Community College to Palm Beach State College. (Some students agreed this actually did make the school more palatable.) But for the most part, the students I spoke with feel grateful they're attending a community college and won't have loans like other people their age.

And if you're so inclined, you can also look into vocational or trade schools, many of whom offer job training for skills like welding and plumbing where people can go on to make six-figure salaries. The stigma and false idea that college indicates excellence and success keeps people for whom this would be a fantastic option from actually pursuing said fantastic option.

Facing money problems after getting a college degree has become all too standard when it doesn't need to be. Even so, among my close friends, no one was willing to go on the record about their parents paying off their loans for them. (I'm mortified my mom was doing it, even if it was behind my back.)

Even Lilly, a currently unemployed American 26-year-old living in Switzerland whom I interviewed, asked that I not use her last name so as not to throw her parents under the bus. (Their friends give them a hard time about paying for their daughter.) She also feels weird about other people knowing. It's one of the biggest stigmas about my generation. How dare we graduate without jobs into a shitty economy and deign to borrow money from our parents to get on our feet! How dare we move back home until we find a job! How dare we let them cover our loans until we are able to do it ourselves (or even accept their paying the loans as a gift if they are able to help us out that way)!